

PLAN FOR SECURING BEST PRODUCING POTATO SEED FOR FOLLOWING SEASON



Harvesting Potatoes—Seed Should Be Selected From the Best Plants.

(Prepared by the United States Department of Agriculture.)

Do not wait until planting time next spring to select your seed potatoes. Do not even wait until harvest time this fall. Begin now by making a study of the plants. This is the plan that should be followed by potato growers who want to have seed that will produce the highest yields. Potato growers should have a seed plot, which may or may not be a part of the main crop, and from the best-growing, disease-resistant plants in this plot, which produce high yields of marketable-sized potatoes, select their seed for the following year. An area of one-tenth or one-fiftieth of the entire acreage will usually provide sufficient seed for the following season's planting.

While it is an advantage to start the seed plot with selected material the work may be begun during the growing season with any good stock of promising quality planted in suitable soil and properly cared for. The best portion of the field therefore should be selected for the seed plot. It should be well drained, frequently cultivated and thoroughly sprayed.

Inspect Seed Plot.

Several times during the growing season the seed plot should be inspected. All weak, degenerate and diseased hills and those showing varietal mixtures should be pulled, so that only the progeny of healthy hills of the correct variety will remain at harvest.

KEEP FARM MACHINERY BUSY

Lazy Binder Works Only Forty Days in Eleven Years—"Work-or-Fight" Policy Applicable.

(Prepared by the United States Department of Agriculture.)

The work-or-fight policy should be applied to farm machinery as well as to men. Though machines cannot fight they can be put to work on many occasions instead of standing idle in the barn lot. Most farm machines and implements are capable of doing much more work than they usually do, and the more they are used the less man labor will be required on the farm. Three men with a corn binder, one operating the machine and two gathering and shocking the bundles, will cut from seven to ten acres a day, while four or five acres would be a fair day's work for the same three men cutting corn by hand.

The average corn binder lasts about eleven years, but during that time does only about forty days' actual work. There is no doubt that it could render several times this much service before wearing out if there were more work to do. There seems to be very little relation between the amount of work done annually by a corn binder and the years of service.

The bulletin refers to a survey conducted in New York state which showed that the more the corn binder could be used each year the less the cost of cutting the corn when the cost of using the binder was taken into consideration. Two hundred and thirty-three of the 458 binders on which data were obtained, cut 15 acres or less annually at a cost of \$9.78 per day used and \$1.67 per acre. The remaining 225 cut over 15 acres annually, averaging 32 1/2 acres, at a cost of \$3.24 per day of service and 57 cents per acre. The original cost of one of these binders was about \$125. Thus if there is only one or two days' work for the binder to do each year, the cost of cutting the corn with it will be so great that its use will not be advisable unless it is impossible to cut the corn by other methods without seriously neglecting other work. If this is the case, the bulletin recommends that two or three neighbors, each of whom has only a small crop, combine in the purchase and operation of a corn binder. The first investment required of each and the machinery cost per acre will then be greatly reduced. This plan should not only apply to corn binders, but to other labor-saving machinery.

USE FOR POULTRY AND EGGS

Considerable Portion of Increase This Year Should Be Used on Farmer's Own Table.

(Prepared by the United States Department of Agriculture.)

As a matter of business foresight and economy, as well as patriotism, farmers who increase their production of poultry and eggs this year should plan to use a considerable part of the increase on their own tables.

BRILLIANT MINDS TO GATHER AT PORTLAND

Oregon will act as host this summer to the National Editorial Association as one of the results of the activities of the Pacific Northwest Tourist Association. This body of men and women is made up of the brightest minds in the newspaper world and the results that will accrue from a publicity standpoint are beyond all computation. During the past two years the Tourist Association

time. Plants showing stem rot either at or below the surface of the soil, plants developing any type of abnormal rolling of the leaves, those with mottled or crinkled leaves, and any plants that are stunted, weakened or that make unthrifty growth, should be discarded.

If practicable it is best to dig the seed plot by hand, care being taken to eliminate all low-yielding hills and those producing an undue proportion of small or unsightly tubers. In harvesting, avoid unnecessary cutting, bruising or other injury, since the vitality of damaged tubers is reduced. Gather and store the seed potatoes in slat crates. Place them as soon as possible after harvesting in a cool reasonably moist storage house provided with good ventilation and maintained at a temperature of 30 to 40 degrees F.

Work Stock Over Carefully.

Before the next planting time the stock should be carefully worked over to remove all badly cut or bruised tubers and those showing serious scab or black scurf and decay of any kind. Tubers badly off type should also be discarded, as should any showing abnormal discoloration of flesh, which can be seen, of course, only at the time of cutting. If scab or black scurf is present in any degree, it is advisable to treat the seed by covering for 30 minutes in a solution containing four ounces of corrosive sublimate to 30 gallons of water.

VALUE OF INSECTICIDE ACT

Farmers Have Been Saved Money by Prevention of Sale of Worthless Preparations.

(Prepared by the United States Department of Agriculture.)

Both the farmer and the manufacturer have been benefited by the enforcement of the insecticide act of 1910.

Farmers have been supplied with insecticides and fungicides that will do what is claimed for them; and have been saved money by prevention of the sale of worthless, low grade, and short-weight preparations, and by prevention of crop or live-stock losses through use of worthless insecticides or fungicides.

The legitimate manufacturer has been protected against the illegitimate manufacturer; confidence in insecticides and fungicides has been created among farmers and stock raisers, and sales have increased; valuable information regarding the manufacture and efficacy of insecticides and fungicides has been given to the manufacturer, enabling him to prepare good preparations and truthful labels.

ADVANTAGES OF VETCH

(Prepared by the United States Department of Agriculture.)

Vetches are gaining in favor in many parts of the United States, for they make excellent feed either green or as hay, and are exceedingly useful as cover or green manure crops. In some respects, particularly their use, they are similar to common red clover, but have the advantage of this crop in that they grow in certain soils and climates where clover does not thrive. About 20 wild kinds occur in this country and are commonly known as wild peas. Only two kinds, namely the common vetch and hairy vetch, are very extensively grown, but other species are likely to become of increasing importance.

CREAM SEPARATOR IS HANDY

Many of Our Farmers Are Neglecting Important Matter of Thorough Separation of Milk.

Approximately one-half of our farmers are still neglecting the important matter of thorough separation of the milk which their herds produce. As a result, from 10 to 25 per cent of the total production of butterfat is not made available to the consumer. The use of the cream separator is worthy of encouragement as an instrument capable of increasing the quantity of food available for human consumption.

Hogs Must Have Pasture.

Raising hogs without plenty of pasture, especially in the West where the grain crop is often short, is a losing venture.

tion representing Oregon, Washington and British Columbia has spent \$112,000 to attract tourists to the Pacific Northwest and the results have been far beyond expectations when war conditions are taken into consideration. That Oregon has received the greater benefit over the other commonwealths is evident in the attendance at Crater Lake. There are 11 National parks in the United States and all but two showed a decrease in attendance except Crater Lake and Rainier National. Crater Lake showed an increase of between

25 to 40 per cent and nearly 50,000 people visited Rainier National while all parts of the Pacific Northwest were included in the various phases of publicity.

The total expenditure of the tourists and vacation seeker per annum is not less than one billion dollars and it is to secure our fair share of this immense revenue that this association exists.

It is safe to say that within a very short time the Pacific Northwest—and it can be demonstrated by figures—can derive from fifty to one hundred million dollars of actual cash from the encouragement of this travel. This cash remains in the Pacific Northwest. It is not sent out for any raw material, nor for any other commodity, but remains here to help every individual citizen in the development of his business and in the payment of his taxes and the tourist is absolutely the fore runner of the settler, the new investor and the manufacturer.

Travel by rail was discouraged last year and as far as going abroad is concerned there will be nothing doing this year. The war is over and the people have the money and a desire to travel. We have so far expended \$112,000, to attract attention to the greatest asset we have and we only need to keep up the work to secure returns based on this expenditure far beyond the desires of the most ambitious. To illustrate: the Park Highway Association at a recent meeting in Spokane reported 10,000 machines entering Spokane over the Yellowstone highway with an average of four in a machine. Suppose these machines were gathered together in Spokane one day. You know what it costs you to travel. Take this amount and multiply it by 10,000 and look at the total and this is the way this new money that costs us practically nothing to get flows in a steady stream into our lap. House Bill 76 calls for another appropriation to cover the coming two years, for the same amount asked for two years ago and dependent upon Washington and British Columbia following with the same amount they gave previously. No appropriation has secured more for Oregon or been better administered. The work is under the constant attention of some of our leading business men who give their time free of charge and pay their own expenses when attending the meetings of the board of directors.

The state revenues are used to develop every other asset, either by maintaining departments, enforcement

ment of laws, maintaining institutions, and the building of roads and bridges and the simplest way to increase these revenues is by a development more potent than any that has gone before which will result in the coming here of thousands of men and women, who will see us as we are and who will in a large measure either remain permanently or leave their money for investments.

Your last chance—Courier and Telegram for \$4.25—offer closes 10th.

Physical Education Needed

"The city child needs physical exercises to develop strength, the country child to give agility and grace," says Dr. A. D. Browne, head of the physical education department at the Oregon Agricultural College. "No habit is more essential than exercise to physical and mental power. Yet no habit is being more universally crowded out by modern methods of manufacture, farming and transportation.

"Thousands of soldiers went away stooping and awkward and have come back erect, strong and self-controlled. Nine-tenths of their training was physical."

A bill prescribing for physical training in the public schools of Oregon has been introduced into the Oregon legislature. The state school superintendent is directed to supervise the training, which will be formulated by a committee of experts.

Get them now—Courier and Telegram for \$4.25—not later than 10th.

Station Hits Tomato Blight

Samples of disease resistant tomato strains, four varieties, have been received at the O. A. C. experiment station by H. P. Barss, plant pathologist, to be tested for resistance to the so-called western blight, which has cut down the crop more than half in many districts of the Columbia river basin. Blight has been the chief factor in discouraging tomato production on a large scale on many of the best tomato soils of the state. The tests will be made in cooperation with county agents as far as possible but experiments can be conducted on a limited scale only unless larger funds are made available to the experiment station for investigations of this kind.

Infant Dies

The one-day-old infant of Mr. and Mrs. Ernest LeMay, of Willamette, died at the Oregon City hospital Tuesday night.

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COMMERCIAL POTATO CROP HARVESTED BY USE OF DIGGER—SORT AND SACK IN FIELD



Horse-Drawn Potato Digger in Operation.

(Prepared by the United States Department of Agriculture.)

Where an early crop is grown, the date of harvesting is largely governed by market conditions. If the price is high, a crop may often be harvested profitably when it is half or two-thirds grown, whereas if prices are low it is generally advisable to allow the tubers to reach full development before they are dug. In the case of late varieties destined for winter consumption it is the usual practice to delay harvesting as long as it is safe to do so without running unnecessary risk of freezing the tubers.

Use Elevator Digger.

With few exceptions, the potato crop is harvested with an elevator digger drawn by horses. When the crop is sold from the field, it is a common practice to sort and sack the potatoes as they are picked up. The sorting or grading of potatoes in the field is most economically done by using a potato grader of the shaker or belt type. These graders are mounted upon a wooden sled and are hauled along by a horse. The sorter has two

screens, arranged one above the other. The diameter of the openings in the upper screen in some graders is 1 1/2 inches and in others 2 inches, while the lower one may have openings anywhere from 1/4 to 1 1/4 inches in diameter. Some makes of graders or sorters have wire-mesh screens with square openings, while others have circular or oblong openings with circular ends.

Pickers and Sorters.

Three pickers usually work with one sorter, each taking a row. The potatoes are picked into wire or split baskets having a ball handle, and as the baskets are filled they are dumped on the upper part of the top screen and then shaken down. The large potatoes passing over the top screen are diverted into one sack and those passing through the upper screen and over the lower go into another sack. One man drives the horse and operates the sorter while another sorts the sacks and assists in loading the wagons. One digger with the necessary crew of men and teams can harvest from three to four acres a day.

OREGON CITY BOY IN EUROPE AT CONFERENCE

Bernard Noble, son of Mr. and Mrs. Charles W. Noble, formerly of this city but now of Portland, is now at the peace conference of nations in Europe, holding an important position. His duties are to translate to the members of the peace conference the contents of 35 daily papers, now received by the assembly.

Mr. Noble was in France for over two years, and was wounded while in action on the front. He is still suffering from the wounds received at that time, and after one engagement, was awarded the distinguished cross for bravery.

"COME IF YOU CAN" CLUB HOLDS MEETING SATURDAY

The first of a series of parties to be given by the "Come If You Can" club, composed of members of the local orders of I. O. O. F. and Rebekahs, was held Saturday night at the I. O. O. F. hall. Cards formed the evening's entertainment, with high scores held by Mrs. J. W. Draper and George Matheson. Refreshments were served during the evening.

Government Locks Close

The government locks on the west side of the river here are to be closed next Sunday, while a new water main is being installed by the Crown-Willamette Paper company. Due to the deepening of the canal some time ago, the company had to take their old main up. The main connects with a large tank on the opposite side of the locks and is essential for fire protection.

Asks for Divorce

Samuel Cooper has entered suit for divorce against his wife, Hazel Cooper, charging in his complaint that she deserted him and took the small child with her. He alleges that since being deserted by his wife, that he has lived alone for over a year. He asks absolute divorce, but signifies his willingness to pay \$20 per month for the support of the child. The couple was married at Duluth, Minn., March 3, 1917.

Speeder Arrested

K. Thompson, who lives on the South End road, was arrested for speeding Wednesday evening by Chief of Police Woodward. He was fined \$10 upon his appearance in court Thursday.